

A2O Technical Baseline Manager

Practical user guide for loading data, connecting technical scope, and preparing a first leadership decision

START SMALL

Build one decision vertical slice before trying to model the entire program. A usable first slice can be one Initiative, one Change Request, one LM Objective, one affected Platform, and the evidence that explains the connection.

What this guide covers

- How to load A2O, Change Request, and LM Objective data without changing source meaning.
- How to distinguish source claims, Government assessment, decisions, and acceptance.
- How to connect a proposed PMA modernization outcome to a Change Request, Objective, Platform, and evidence.
- How to prepare a clear one-pager without overstating unknown scope, dates, or funding.

Worked example

The guide uses a hypothetical Government outcome: **Reduce PMA service interruptions through a future PMA modernization decision**. It is illustrative. Replace names, identifiers, releases, and statements with your approved source material.

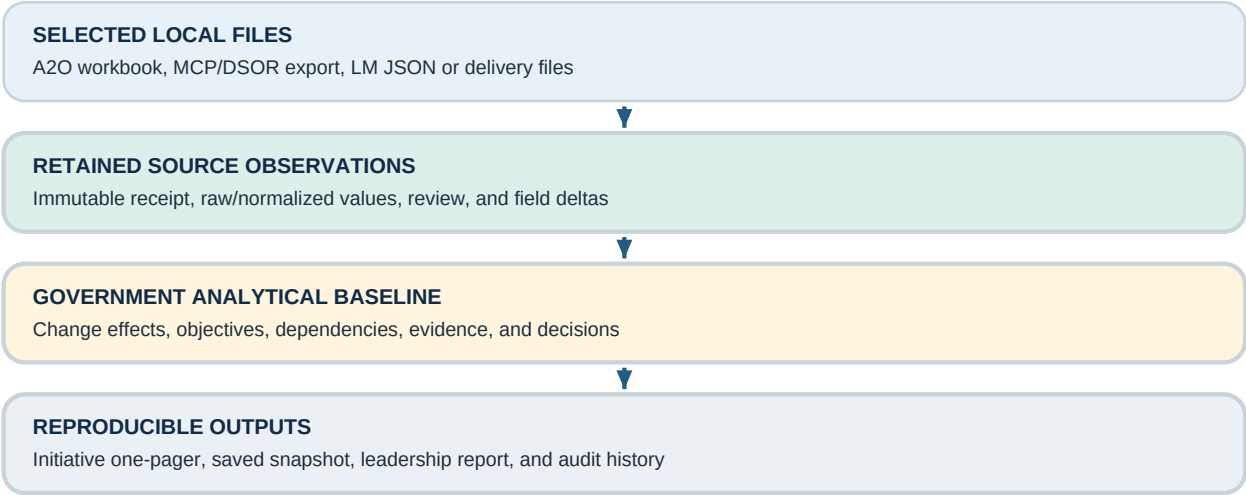
Version 1.0 | Meeting-readiness branch

1. Start with the operating boundary

The application is an editable Government analytical baseline. It preserves selected-source receipts and helps connect them to analysis and leadership decisions. It does not replace the contractor's source system or declare a source file to be an official program record.

Before a working session	Why
Confirm the app is running at <code>http://127.0.0.1:3000</code> .	The local runtime is loopback-only.
Keep source files in an approved local folder.	The app reads the specific file you select; it does not fetch Confluence, GitLab, Lockheed, or another external system.
Run <code>npm run local:backup</code> before a major import and at end of session.	The local database and uploaded evidence are operational data, not Git content.
Leave a date blank when it is not known.	Blank means not established. It is more accurate than an invented placeholder.

DATA AND DECISION CHAIN



The application records what was supplied, what was assessed, and what was decided without treating them as the same thing.

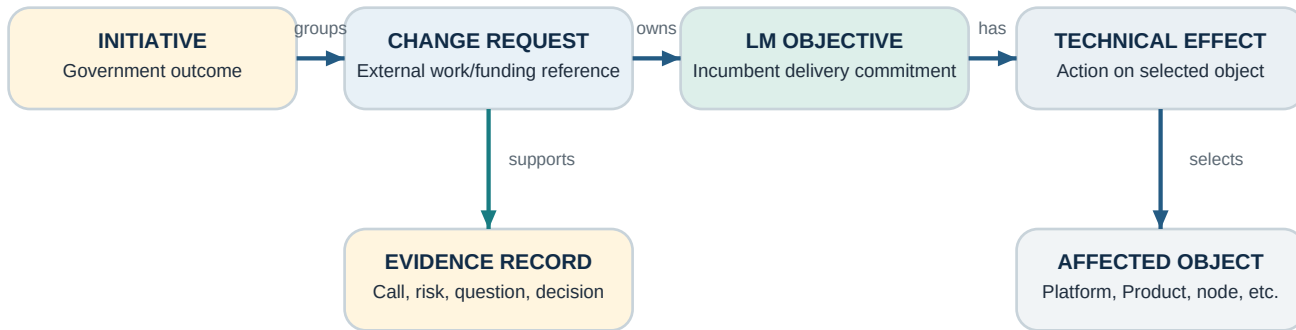
FIRST QUESTION

Before adding data, write a single sentence: What Government decision needs better technical evidence?
Example: Should the Government direct and fund a bounded PMA modernization package to reduce service interruptions?

2. Understand the relationships before entering them

The data becomes useful when the connections are explicit. A title that happens to match another title is not a relationship. Select the related governed record or create the correct one.

ONE DECISION VERTICAL SLICE



An Objective may be attributed to the Change Request effect it implements. A dependency is not an ownership link.

Use the relationships for their actual purpose:

Relationship	Use it for	Do not use it for
Initiative -> Change Request	Grouping funding or direction units under a Government outcome.	A statement that every item in a release is automatically in scope.
Change Request -> technical effect	A bounded action on a Product, Platform, configuration node, baseline record, Release, or Organization.	A vague implementation narrative without an affected object.
Change Request -> LM Objective	The accountable Objective delivery relationship.	Treating every reported JPO/MCP reference as ownership.
Objective -> technical effect attribution	Showing which effect the Objective implements.	Replacing ownership or a dependency record.
Evidence record -> governed object	Making the source or assessment discoverable with the thing it supports.	Duplicating the object in free text.

SCOPE RULE

Initiative technical scope is derived from the affected objects on linked Change Requests and Objective effect attributions. The optional Release lens organizes the decision view; it does not turn every baseline record in that release into scope.

3. Read claims, analysis, decisions, and acceptance correctly

The labels are factual context. They tell a reader what kind of information they are viewing rather than trying to persuade them that it is good or bad.

HOW TO READ INFORMATION STATUS

SOURCE CLAIM

What was supplied.
Not a Government conclusion.

GOVERNMENT ASSESSMENT

Analysis or judgment.
Not a decision.

GOVERNMENT DECISION

Authority + date + rationale.

VERIFICATION / ACCEPTANCE

Evidence + criterion or signoff.
A seal alone is not acceptance.

Status labels preserve context; they do not make a case for a preferred conclusion.

When you see	Interpret it as	Next useful action
Source claim	What an external source or supplier reported.	Retain the receipt and compare it to the prior observation.
Government assessment	Analysis, uncertainty, or an analyst judgment.	Link the basis and identify what would confirm or reject it.
Government decision	An adjudicated direction only when authority, date, and rationale are present.	Retain the decision record and its affected links.
Integrity sealed file	The retained bytes match the recorded file.	Link it to a criterion or signoff before calling it acceptance evidence.

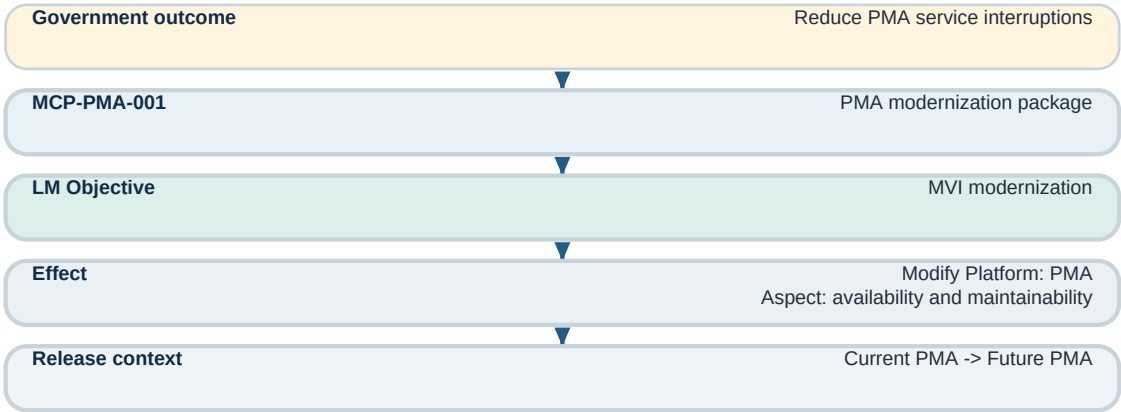
EVIDENCE RECORD

When creating a call, risk, question, technical note, or decision, set Information origin independently from Record lifecycle. For an approved decision, enter the decision authority, date, and rationale. A lifecycle value alone is not an adjudicated decision.

4. Worked example: PMA availability decision

Use an outcome-oriented Initiative name when possible. Instead of only naming a solution, state the operational result the Government seeks.

WORKED EXAMPLE: PMA AVAILABILITY DECISION



Do not add every installed Product or baseline row unless the Change Request explicitly affects it.

Record	Example entry	Purpose
Initiative	Reduce PMA service interruptions	Government outcome and leadership decision context.
Decision ask	Direct and fund a bounded PMA modernization analysis and implementation package.	Specific Government direction needed.
Change Request	MCP-PMA-001 - PMA modernization package	External work/funding reference.
LM Objective	MVI modernization	Incumbent delivery commitment owned by the Change Request.
Technical effect	Modify Platform: PMA. Aspect: availability and maintainability.	Actual technical scope.
Release context	Current PMA Release -> Future PMA Release	Effect context only, not automatic scope.

WHOLE-PLATFORM CHANGE

For a whole-platform modernization, select Platform -> PMA as the affected object. Do not select every installed Product merely because it is on PMA. Add a Product only when it changes in its own right, such as a replacement, version transition, or retirement.

5. Load data in the right order

Use Import Hub & Quality for selected local source files. Preview before you apply. The retained receipt and the review decision matter as much as the resulting canonical records.

File in hand	Import Hub action	What it provides
Current 24-column A2O XLSX	Import A2O workbook	Release, Product, baseline-record, and reported configuration context.
Confluence MCP/DSOR CSV or XLSX	Import Change Request export	Change Request references and source-controlled fields.
FOR_JPO.json	Import Objective JSON	LM Objective source observations, reported JPO/MCP references, dependency references, and deltas.
CAPES, JIRA, MCPS, or OBJS delivery CSV/XLSX	Import daily delivery	Source observations for capabilities, requests, or Objectives.

For every import

- Identify the file and source-as-of date accurately.
- Review new, changed, unchanged, removed, and blocked items before mutation.
- Resolve a true invalid or duplicate identity; skip a row that should not change the analytical baseline.
- Apply approved rows, then inspect the relevant Change Request or Objective history.
- Treat a removed source item as historical evidence, not a deletion instruction for governed records.

LM OBJECTIVE CAUTION

A reported JPO/MCP value is a trace reference. It does not automatically create Government ownership, funding approval, a delivery owner, or a fixed Release commitment.

6. Describe Platforms, nodes, VMs, and installations

Open Platforms, select the Platform and the Release you are describing. The model intentionally separates stable identity from Release-specific facts.

Stable identity	Release-specific state
Node code, name, node type, serial number, manufacturer, hardware Product	Parent placement, CPU cores, memory, storage, lifecycle, operating state, source reference, source date
Create once	Create or edit for each Release where the configuration differs

To edit CPU, memory, storage, or parent placement

- Open the Platform and choose the intended Release.
- In Release node register, select **Edit capacity & Release state**.
- Record the measured, reported, or planned value with its source basis and date.
- Save the state for that Release. Do not rewrite an earlier Release state.

To add a virtual machine

- Select **Add infrastructure node / VM** and choose **Virtual machine**.
- Select its host as parent in the selected Release.
- Add operating system, hypervisor, application, or other software as installed Products when known.

DO NOT INVENT CONFIGURATION

A node, VM, container, connection, or Product installation should exist only when it is sourced or deliberately recorded as an assessment. Unknown is an acceptable state.

7. Complete Change Request analysis and dependencies

The external system remains authoritative for its own lifecycle. This app records Government priority, consequence, technical effects, dependencies, and the fund/defer/decline decision reference.

Minimum Change Request analysis	What good looks like
External identifier, source system, source-as-of	A reader can locate the source claim and date.
Government priority	The current Government prioritization is visible and separate from source scoring.
Funded and deferred consequences	The decision tradeoff is stated plainly.
Technical effects	Each uses a selected affected object, action, aspect, value transition if known, and status.
Dependencies	Material prerequisite or conflict has rationale, source, owner, and information status.

Relationship	Use it when	Example
Requires	The successor cannot proceed without the predecessor.	PMA fielding requires an approved environment change.
Enables	The predecessor makes successor work possible or easier.	Infrastructure assessment enables the PMA package.
Blocks	The predecessor prevents successor work from progressing.	An unresolved security exception blocks fielding.
Conflicts	The requests compete or cannot coexist as planned.	Two changes reserve the same maintenance window.
Overlaps	Work shares scope or timing without a stronger dependency.	Two analysis packages inspect PMA.

FINISH-TO-FINISH

Use the work-package dependency control for a true finish-to-finish scheduling constraint: the successor cannot finish until the predecessor finishes. Do not turn a vague note into a dependency; name the actual prerequisite and the consequence if it is unmet.

8. Create the Initiative and let scope derive

Create the Initiative after the first Change Request is meaningfully described. Enter the Government outcome, owner, priority, decision ask, desired outcome, and consequence if deferred. The optional Release lens is for the decision view, not a manual scope selector.

Then link the Change Request, confirm the Objective ownership and effect attribution, and add requirements, milestones, acceptance criteria, evidence, and Government work packages as they become available.

If this is true	Then do this
The whole PMA Platform changes	Link Platform -> PMA to the Change Request as an affected object.
A specific Product changes	Add the Product effect separately and describe the action and aspect.
Only a specific fielded row changes	Link that baseline record explicitly; it will count in derived baseline scope.
Future dates are only proposed	Leave unknown dates blank; retain the proposal as a source claim or assessment.
Objective work implements an effect	Create the explicit Objective-effect attribution in Technical scope.

CHECK THE RESULT

Open the Initiative and review Derived technical scope. For the PMA example, one Platform effect should appear as one affected Platform. It should not inflate to every Product or baseline record unless those objects were explicitly affected.

Useful Initiative completion sequence

- Link each decision-driving Change Request.
- Confirm Objectives are owned, and attribute the effects they implement.
- Add requirements and Tier 3/Tier 4 acceptance criteria only when the actual statements and evidence paths are known.
- Expose unknowns as readiness gaps rather than hiding them in a generic note.

9. Prepare the first leadership one-pager

A good first one-pager is not a complete implementation plan. It is a reproducible statement of the decision, known technical scope, linked evidence, and material gaps.

One-pager element	Ready when
Decision	The action, authority, and decision-needed date are plain language.
As-Is	The current condition is sourced or clearly shown as an assessment/gap.
To-Be	The target is bounded and not presented as already funded.
Change Requests	Each decision unit has a consequence and at least one useful technical effect.
Objectives	Each is owned and attributed to a technical effect where applicable.
Technical scope	Derived affected objects match the decision; release context does not overclaim scope.
Evidence and acceptance	Evidence is linked, and a seal is not misrepresented as acceptance.

Suggested first narrative

PMA EXAMPLE

The Government needs direction on a bounded PMA modernization package. Supplier-reported planning and technical scope require validation. The Initiative currently identifies the PMA Platform as the affected object; individual Product and baseline-record effects will be added only when supported by Change Request analysis.

- Use **Open leadership one-pager** for the current live decision sheet.
- Use **Save report snapshot** when the current content should become a frozen, auditable record.
- Include the traceability annex when necessary detail does not fit on the first page.

FROZEN MEANS FROZEN

A saved report does not silently change when source observations, effects, or analysis are edited later. Create a new snapshot when a later state should be briefed.

10. Daily and meeting rhythm

Use a repeatable cadence so that incoming source changes become visible, assessable, and traceable rather than getting lost in email or standups.

Moment	Repeatable action
Daily source intake	Save the received file unchanged, import it, review the preview, apply approved rows, and inspect retained deltas.
Before a technical touchpoint	Open the Change Request, Objective, Platform, and Release. Separate reported dependencies from accepted Government dependencies.
During/after the touchpoint	Create an Evidence record for material facts, assessments, questions, actions, and decisions. Link it to the affected objects.
Before leadership	Review derived scope, evidence labels, decision consequence, readiness gaps, and the live one-pager.
End of session	Export when needed, run <code>npm run local:backup</code> , and copy the result to an approved location.

Common corrections

Situation	Correct action
A reported JPO changed	Import the observation, inspect the retained delta, and do not overwrite Government ownership automatically.
A date is unknown	Leave it blank and record the uncertainty or source claim.
A whole Platform is affected	Link the Platform; add Products only when individually affected.
A source file is attached	Set the record information origin and link a criterion/signoff before claiming acceptance.
Scope changed without notice	Retain the new source snapshot, inspect the history, and make an assessment or decision record when material.

11. End-of-session checklist

- ☐ Reviewed import results and blocking findings.
- ☐ Confirmed material Change Request effects point to selected real objects.
- ☐ Confirmed Objectives are owned and attributed where required.
- ☐ Kept uncertain information labeled as a source claim or Government assessment.
- ☐ Recorded authority, date, and rationale for every approved decision record.
- ☐ Saved a leadership snapshot only when the source state is ready to retain.
- ☐ Ran npm run local:backup and copied the backup to an approved location.

Reference material in this repository

File	Use it for
README.md	Local setup, updates, backups, and operating boundaries.
docs/GOVERNED_IMPORTS.md	Import rules, review behavior, and source adapters.
docs/AUTHORITATIVE_DATA_MODEL.md	Object ownership, relationships, and deliberate boundaries.
docs/INFRASTRUCTURE_CONFIGURATION_MODEL.md	Platforms, nodes, VMs, installations, and connections.
docs/LOCAL_OPERATOR_RUNBOOK.md	Detailed operator, update, transfer, backup, and recovery procedures.

USEFUL, NOT OVERSTATED

The goal is to make the data, its source, its relationships, and its gaps visible. A smaller accurate decision slice is more valuable than a complete-looking model with unsupported scope or assumptions.